



Preliminary investigation update

Haul truck and light vehicle collision, Bindarra Gold Mine -
Preliminary investigation update

Drafted 04/10/2026

INVESTIGATION WORKFLOW SUITE

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Summary

On 12/08/2026 at 02:47, in the Stage 4 pit at Bindarra Gold Mine, a descending haul truck struck the right side of a light vehicle entering the main ramp from the new RL 312 dewatering spur. The impact pushed the light vehicle 18.4 m down the ramp and rolled it onto its left side. The driver, a survey subcontractor's grade control technician, sustained a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax (air around the lung) and was flown out. The light vehicle was destroyed, the truck was damaged at the front left, and the pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes. The investigation is examining how new roads reach the mine's traffic controls, the intersection's sight line and signage, collision awareness alert suppression, contractor access to the pit and night shift arrangements, and the question of dust remains open. Positive radio calls are now required at every Stage 4 intersection, and reporting of suppressed collision awareness events is being implemented.

What we know

On 02/08/2026 the RL 312 dewatering spur opened to light vehicles in the Stage 4 open pit at Bindarra Gold Mine. It is a new 240 m access road cut under works order WO-26-4471. Its construction sign was removed that day, and no sign, give-way control or delineation replaced it. The spur joins the main ramp 34 m beyond a crest high point. By survey, a descending truck operator first sees the spur mouth at 41 m, and a driver at the mouth first sees a descending truck at 38 m. The truck's in-cab road map, last published on 24/07/2026, did not show the spur.

At about 22:10 on 04/08/2026 a dewatering technician came out of the spur about 60 m ahead of a descending haul truck. He reversed, let it pass and reported it that night. The Dewatering Superintendent closed the report on 06/08/2026 after the crew were reminded to take care and give way to haul trucks. It was not referred to the mining department, the contractor, the survey department or the traffic management plan owner.

On 09/08/2026 a survey subcontractor's grade control technician was issued a site access card against his employer's recognition agreement. There is no record that he completed the site-specific supplement or the light vehicle pit driving assessment.

On 12/08/2026, his third night shift, he left the bore collar in LV-118 at about 02:45 (estimated from the scene and spur length). He recalls a time later than the recorded collision. Neither driver radioed before the intersection, which is not among the nine where the traffic management plan requires a call.

Haul truck HT-407, descending empty, was recorded at 37 km/h at 02:47:06, 41 m above the intersection. The occurrence notification states that "Neither operator saw the other until the two vehicles were about 41 m apart." Braking and 14 degrees of right steering began 1.4 seconds later. At 02:47:09 the collision awareness system logged LV-118 at 21.4 m but gave no alert, because the intersection lay inside the S4-LOAD suppression geofence (a mapped area where alerts are switched off). At 02:47:12 the truck's front left struck LV-118's right side at 24 km/h, pushing it 18.4 m down the ramp and rolling it onto its left side.

Dispatch stopped all Stage 4 traffic at 02:48:01. The emergency response team was paged at 02:48 and arrived at 02:54, with a further arrival at 03:07. The second responder arrived with the rescue tool, and the driver was extricated, both at 03:14. He had a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax (air around the lung), and was flown out at 07:40. LV-118 was destroyed. Its roll-over protection was deformed but not breached, and the fastened seatbelt showed loading marks. HT-407 returned to service on 14/08/2026. Drug and alcohol tests on the truck operator and supervisor were negative. The pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes.

What we are looking at

1. **How new roads reach the traffic controls.** The investigation is examining how the RL 312 spur was cut and opened under works order WO-26-4471 without a management of change record. It is also examining why the traffic management plan, the in-cab road map and the collision awareness system settings were not updated, given that eleven of fourteen new Stage 4 roads were never referred to the plan's owner. This includes how intersections are added to the nine where positive radio calls are required, and how the discretion left to sites by guideline MSG-14 shapes that process.
2. **The intersection itself.** The investigation is examining why the intersection had 41 m of sight line against the plan's 120 m minimum and carried no sign, give-way control or delineation. It is also examining how the dewatering technician's hazard report of 04/08/2026 was assessed and closed.
3. **The collision awareness system.** The investigation is examining how the S4-LOAD suppression geofence was extended on 09/06/2026 and how changes to it are reviewed and communicated. It is also examining why suppressed proximity events, including nine involving light vehicles on the main ramp, were not reported to anyone.
4. **Contractor access to the pit.** The investigation is examining how a site access card was issued without checking the site-specific supplement and the light vehicle pit driving assessment that the site standard says may not be substituted. The contractor's own training records for the supplement are still being obtained.
5. **Night shift arrangements.** The investigation is examining the Stage 4 night roster worked by haul truck operators. It is also examining the night shift emergency response arrangement, in which the second responder needed for any extrication is called in from the village, and how that roster applies across the site's other night shifts.
6. **Dust on the ramp.** Whether dust affected what the truck operator could see was examined against the water cart log, the dust monitor and both drivers' accounts, and could not be resolved. It remains open.

Containment and next steps

Two interim safety actions have been taken since the collision. Neither indicates that any cause has been determined.

- **Positive radio calls at every Stage 4 intersection.** At 05:10 on 12/08/2026 the Mining Manager issued a site-wide direction. It requires a positive call on the pit channel before entering any intersection in the Stage 4 pit, whether or not the traffic management plan lists it. The direction was read at the following four pre-starts and posted beside the Appendix B board in the Stage 4 crib room. It is in force and stands until BIN-TMP-004 is amended.
- **Reporting of suppressed collision awareness events.** On 28/08/2026 Warrigal technical services added suppressed proximity events to the monthly collision awareness report, broken down by geofence and by vehicle class. Suppressed proximity events are those the system logged inside a suppression geofence without raising an alert. Technical services also re-ran the previous twelve months on the same basis for the Stage 4 fleet. The first report was due on 30/09/2026, and the action is still being implemented.

The next steps in the investigation are:

- obtaining the contractor's own training records for the site-specific supplement, and holding a second conversation with the light vehicle driver;
- obtaining the night shift responder roster across the site's other three night shifts from the emergency response coordinator;
- finalising the interview write-ups;
- completing the analysis of the matters listed above, with the dust question reported as open because the available evidence cannot resolve it; and
- arranging an independent review of the draft report, and giving the people and areas it describes the chance to correct matters of fact.

The fuller report is expected [NOT ESTABLISHED: expected date or timeframe for the final report].

Distribution

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